Retrofit or Design?

Some course practices are added later for one student who asks. Others are built in from the start for everyone. Your group sorts eight of them, prices the ones students have to ask for, and designs two replacements.

A WHAT IS ON YOUR TABLE

- 8 **Practice cards, A to H.** Lay them face up in a row. They stay in the row.
- 2 **Blank cards,** G′ and H′, for step 3.
- 1 **Recorder sheet.** Everything you write goes here.
- 3 **Principle cards.** Engagement, Representation, Action & Expression.
- 2 **Labels,** Retrofit and Designed in, for reference.

Groups of three or four. Pick a reader and a recorder before you start.

B WHAT YOU DO

1. **Sort in pairs (8 min).** The cards come in three pairs: A and B, C and D, E and F. Each pair meets one need in two ways.
   - The reader reads one pair aloud.
   - The group says which card is the retrofit and which is designed in.
   - For the designed-in card, the group picks the principle card it matches.
   - The recorder writes one line per pair, for example: *C retrofit. D designed in, Representation.*

   G and H have no partner yet. Skip them until step 3.

2. **Price the retrofits (10 min).** Five cards are retrofits: A, C, E, G, H. For each one, answer three questions, and the recorder writes one line per card.
   - What must a student say or show to get this, and to whom?
   - How many times in a semester, across how many courses?
   - What happens to the student who never discloses?

3. **Design the missing pair (8 min).** On card G′, write a designed-in version of G. On card H′, write a designed-in version of H. Under each, write the principle it uses.
   - Model, done for A: *Every in-class writing session ends with a 24-hour window to revise and resubmit online.* Same need as A, no request needed, principle Action & Expression.

4. **Report (4 min).** Two groups read one new card aloud and name its principle. The room answers one question: what does the designed-in version lose, if anything?

C REFERENCE

Retrofit: added later, for one student, on request. Dolmage: "adding ramps at the sides of buildings and making accommodations to the standard curriculum."

Designed in: built into the course from the start, for everyone, with no request needed.

Principle cards: CAST UDL Guidelines 3.0 (2024). Quotations and page numbers are on the session page.

Recorder Sheet

One person writes. Group members: _____

1 SORT IN PAIRS

One line per pair: which is the retrofit, which is designed in, and the principle the designed-in card matches.

A and B _____

C and D _____

E and F _____

2 PRICE THE RETROFITS

One line per card: what the student must say or show, to whom, how often, and what happens to the student who never discloses.

A _____

C _____

E _____

G _____

H _____

3 DESIGN THE MISSING PAIR

Write the new practices on cards G′ and H′. Note the principle here.

G′ principle _____

H′ principle _____

4 REPORT

If your group reads aloud: which card, and what does the designed-in version lose, if anything?

Loses _____

A

Extended time on in-class writing for students with a Disability Resource Office letter.

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B

Every deadline carries a 48-hour grace window, no request needed.

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C

Slides shared after class with students who have a note-taking accommodation.

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D

Slides and a one-page outline posted before every class for everyone.

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E

Captions added to course videos once a Deaf student enrolls.

ENG 511 · NOV 3 · RETROFIT OR DESIGN?

F

Every video captioned and transcribed before the term begins.

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G

A separate quiet room for the one timed in-class essay, for students with documented need.

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H

Students who apply through the DRO receive an alternative to the required oral presentation.

ENG 511 · NOV 3 · RETROFIT OR DESIGN?

G′

Designed-in version of G. Principle beneath.

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H′

Designed-in version of H. Principle beneath.

ENG 511 · NOV 3 · STEP 3

Retrofit

Added later, for one student, on request. "Adding ramps at the sides of buildings and making accommodations to the standard curriculum" (Dolmage).

ENG 511 · NOV 3 · REFERENCE LABEL

Designed In

Built into the course from the start, for everyone, with no request needed.

ENG 511 · NOV 3 · REFERENCE LABEL

UDL PRINCIPLE 1

Engagement

The why of learning: interest, sustained effort, fewer threats and distractions.

Ask of a practice: does it lower the cost of staying with the work, for everyone, without a request?

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UDL PRINCIPLE 2

Representation

The what of learning: information in more than one form, such as text, audio, visual, or an outline.

Ask of a practice: does the same content reach students by more than one route, before anyone asks?

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UDL PRINCIPLE 3

Action & Expression

The how of learning: more than one way to respond and show learning, with support for planning and pacing.

Ask of a practice: does it give every student a choice of form or pace, with scaffolding built in?

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UDL PRINCIPLE 3

Action & Expression

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